

Typhoid (Vi Polysaccharide Vaccine)

Patient Group Direction, version 002, issued 7 September 2026. Standalone document.

Scope of this PGD

This PGD authorises the administration of Vi polysaccharide typhoid vaccine for travellers to areas where typhoid is a risk.

- **This is now a standalone document. Version 001 was the middle third of a combined hepatitis A, typhoid and cholera file, so a pharmacist opening the typhoid service landed on a hepatitis A PGD and had to scroll past it. Hepatitis A and cholera are covered by their own documents.**
- **This PGD covers the INJECTABLE Vi polysaccharide vaccine only. It does not cover oral live typhoid vaccine (Ty21a, Vivotif), which is a live vaccine with entirely different handling, contraindications and interval rules. If your pharmacy stocks the oral vaccine it is not covered here.**
- **Observe every patient for 15 minutes after vaccination.**
- **Vaccine efficacy is roughly 70 to 80%. Food and water hygiene advice is not optional and must be given and recorded in every case.**
- **The vaccine does not protect against paratyphoid A or B.**

Typhoid Vi polysaccharide vaccine

Patient Group Direction for the administration of Vi polysaccharide typhoid vaccine (Typhim Vi or equivalent) for travellers aged 2 years and over.

Healthcare professionals covered, and training

- Pharmacist registered and practising with the GPhC.
- Pharmacy technician registered and practising with the GPhC. Typhoid Vi vaccine is not a controlled drug, so registered pharmacy technicians may lawfully supply and administer under this PGD (Human Medicines Regulations 2012 as amended, 26 June 2024).
- All users must be trained to the National Minimum Standards and Core Curriculum for Immunisation Training, and be competent in intramuscular vaccination technique.
- All users must be competent in the recognition and immediate management of anaphylaxis, and hold current basic life support training.
- All users must be competent in destination risk assessment using current NaTHNaC / TravelHealthPro country recommendations.
- All users must be competent in assessing consent in children and young people, including parental responsibility and Gillick competence.
- All users must be competent in vaccine handling and cold chain management.
- Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer and practise only within the bounds of their own competence.

The PGD

Indication	Active immunisation against typhoid fever caused by Salmonella Typhi, for travellers aged 2 years and over going to areas where typhoid is a risk, in accordance with Green Book chapter 33 and current NaTHNaC / TravelHealthPro country guidance.
Inclusion criteria	• Aged 2 years and over. Note this PGD covers children; version 001 restricted all its arms to 18 and over, which was narrower than the licence. • Travelling to an area where typhoid vaccination is recommended, established from current NaTHNaC / TravelHealthPro guidance and recorded. • At least 2 weeks before departure, so that protection can develop. Where travel is sooner, vaccination may still be given but the traveller must be told protection may be incomplete, and that must be recorded. • Valid informed consent obtained. Where the patient is under 16, from a person with parental responsibility, or from the young person where assessed as Gillick competent, with the basis of the assessment recorded. • No exclusion criterion present.
Exclusion criteria	Refer, do not vaccinate, where any of the following applies. • Under 2 years of age. The Vi polysaccharide vaccine produces a poor response below 2 years. Refer. • Confirmed anaphylactic reaction to a previous dose of typhoid vaccine, or to any component of the product held. • Acute severe febrile illness. Postpone until recovered. A minor illness without fever is not a reason to defer. • A dose of typhoid Vi vaccine within the last 3 years, unless the traveller is returning to a risk area and the previous dose is due for renewal. Record the previous dose date. • Any fever following recent travel to a typhoid risk area. Typhoid is a notifiable illness and a febrile returning traveller needs urgent assessment, not vaccination. • Under 16 with no person with parental responsibility available to consent, and not assessed as Gillick competent.
Cautions	• Pregnancy and breastfeeding. This is an inactivated polysaccharide

	vaccine and may be given where the risk of typhoid is significant and travel is unavoidable. Discuss and record the decision. • Immunosuppression: the vaccine may be given but the response may be reduced. Advise that protection may be lower and that food and water hygiene matters more, not less. • Bleeding disorders or anticoagulation: use a fine needle (23 gauge or finer) and apply firm pressure without rubbing for at least 2 minutes. • The vaccine does not protect against paratyphoid A or B, which cause a clinically similar illness. Say so.
Actions if the patient is excluded or declines	Explain why vaccination cannot be given and what the alternative is. Where the patient is under 2, refer to a travel clinic or the GP. Where there is fever following travel to a risk area, refer for urgent same-day assessment and say plainly that typhoid must be excluded. In every case give food and water hygiene advice, which is the main protection regardless of vaccination status. Document the advice and the decision.

The medicine

Name, form and strength	Typhoid Vi polysaccharide vaccine, 25 micrograms in 0.5 mL, solution for injection in a pre-filled syringe (Typhim Vi or equivalent Vi polysaccharide product).
Legal category	POM.
Route and method	Intramuscular injection, 0.5 mL. Deltoid in adults and children aged 2 and over. Do not give intravascularly.
Dose and frequency	A single 0.5 mL dose, given at least 2 weeks before travel.
Booster	A booster dose every 3 years for those with continued or repeated exposure. Record the date the next booster is due.
Quantity	One dose per patient per attendance. This PGD does not permit supply of vaccine to the patient for administration elsewhere.
Adverse effects	Very common: injection site pain, redness and swelling. Common: malaise, headache, myalgia, mild fever. Uncommon: nausea, abdominal pain. Rare: urticaria, Guillain-Barre syndrome, anaphylaxis.
Anaphylaxis and observation	Adrenaline (epinephrine) 1 in 1,000 injection must be immediately available whenever a vaccine is administered under this PGD, together with a written anaphylaxis protocol consistent with current Resuscitation Council UK guidance and a telephone. All staff administering vaccines must be trained in the recognition and immediate management of anaphylaxis and must hold current basic life support training. Observe every patient for 15 minutes after vaccination. Vaccinate seated.
Yellow Card reporting	Report suspected adverse reactions via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP.
Records to be kept	• That valid informed consent was given, and from whom. Where the patient is a child, the person with parental responsibility or the basis of the Gillick assessment. • Patient name, address, date of birth, and the GP with whom they are registered. • Name and brand of vaccine, batch number and expiry date. • Date of administration, dose, route and anatomical site used. • Destination, itinerary and departure date, and the source consulted for the recommendation. • The date any previous typhoid dose was given, where known, and the date the next booster is due.

	• Name and registration number of the healthcare professional administering. • Advice given, including food and water hygiene advice and the post-travel fever warning. • Details of any adverse drug reactions and the actions taken. • That the vaccine was administered under this PGD. Records signed, dated, legible and contemporaneous. Adults: 8 years. Under 18s: until the 25th birthday.
Storage and cold chain	Store at +2C to +8C in the original packaging to protect from light. Do not freeze; discard if frozen. COLD CHAIN EXCURSION: vaccine exposed to conditions outside the stated range must be quarantined and risk assessed in accordance with UKHSA Vaccine Incident Guidance before any further use. Do not administer excursion stock until that assessment is complete.
Disposal	Dispose of used syringes and needles in a UN-approved puncture-resistant sharps container in accordance with local arrangements and HTM 07-01.
Co-administration	May be given at the same time as other travel vaccines. Use a separate limb where possible, or sites at least 2.5 cm apart in the same limb. Record the site used for each vaccine.

Information for the patient

Written information	Supply the patient information leaflet for the product given, and the Get Real Health food and water hygiene sheet.
Counselling	• This vaccine is about 70 to 80% effective. It reduces your risk; it does not remove it. • Food and water care is your main protection. Boil it, cook it, peel it, or leave it. Avoid ice, salads washed in local water, unpasteurised dairy and food from street stalls that is not cooked in front of you. • It does not protect against paratyphoid, which causes a very similar illness. • It takes about 2 weeks to work, so it is worth having in good time before you go. • If you develop a fever, headache and feel increasingly unwell during or after your trip, see a doctor and tell them where you have been. Typhoid can present weeks after you return. • A sore arm, mild fever and feeling off for a day or two afterwards is common and settles by itself. • If you travel to risk areas regularly, you need a booster every 3 years.
Follow-up	No routine follow-up. Seek medical attention for fever during or after travel and disclose the travel history. Return in 3 years for a booster if you continue to travel to risk areas.

Appendix 1 — Food and water hygiene advice

Give this in every case, whether or not the traveller is vaccinated. The vaccine is roughly 70 to 80% effective and does not cover paratyphoid.

- Drink bottled water with an intact seal, or water that has been boiled. Avoid ice.
- Avoid salads and uncooked vegetables washed in local water.
- Eat food that is thoroughly cooked and still hot. Avoid food that has been standing.
- Peel fruit yourself.
- Avoid unpasteurised milk and dairy products.
- Wash hands before eating, with soap or an alcohol-based gel.

Appendix 2 — The post-travel fever warning

Typhoid has an incubation period of one to three weeks and can present after the traveller is home. Any fever during or after travel to a risk area should prompt medical assessment with the travel history disclosed.

Appendix 3 — What this PGD does not cover

- **Oral live typhoid vaccine (Ty21a, Vivotif).** It is a live vaccine with different contraindications, different interval rules with other live vaccines and antibiotics, and different storage. It is not covered here.
- Children under 2 years.
- Treatment of suspected typhoid. That is a medical emergency.
- Hepatitis A and cholera, which have their own documents.

Authorisation

Version	v002
Supersedes	Version 001 (combined hepatitis A, typhoid and cholera document)
Valid from date	7 September 2026
Expiry date	31 July 2027

Doctor	Name: Nitin Shori Job title: Medical Director, Get Real Health GMC: 6047293 Signed: N. Shori Date: 7 September 2026
Pharmacist	Name: Chris Pilkington Job title: Head Pharmacist, Get Real Health GPhC: 2046322 Signed: C. Pilkington Date: 7 September 2026

Both authorising signatories reviewed this version together on 7 September 2026 and gave their authorisation for it to be issued. Signatures were applied digitally on their joint instruction, which is the established process for Get Real Health PGDs.

Adoption by the employing organisation

To be completed by the adopting pharmacy. These signatories are the adopting organisation own signatories and must not be pre-filled by Get Real Health.

Superintendent / clinical	Name:
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lead	Job title and organisation: Signature: Date:
Professional group signatory	Name: Job title and organisation: Signature: Date:

Change history

Version	v002
Date	7 September 2026
Changes	• Full clinical review and reissue as a standalone document.